TANTRA

Stop, fix or scale.

Three numbers per channel, once a week. Read bounces first.

Stop
bounces over 5%

Fix
click-through under 1%

Scale
3% click-through, 1.5% conversion, 2% bounces

STOP

Bounces over 5%.

Pause that campaign today. It’s a list or inbox problem, not copy. Check the list source, then one SPF record, a DKIM key and DMARC.

FIX

Bounces 2% or less. Click-through under 1%.

Now it’s the message. Rewrite the offer line, change one thing, split next week’s list in half. Between 2% and 5% bounces: clean the list first.

SCALE

3%+ click-through, 1.5%+ conversion, 2% or fewer bounces.

All three clear the bar. Raise volume, inside your daily sending caps.

Why pause at 5%?

Mailchimp: a typical campaign bounces **1% to 2%**. Review the list above 2%. Review it urgently above **5%**.

SendGrid recommends hard bounces under **5%** of attempted sends.

A bouncing inbox burns the domain you spent two weeks warming.

Sources: Mailchimp, “How to Reduce Email Bounce Rates” (2026); Twilio SendGrid docs.

Never judge cold email on opens.

Since Apple’s Mail Privacy Protection launched in 2021, senders can’t reliably tell when an email was opened.

Read clicks and registrations instead.

A blank is not a zero.

A channel that doesn’t report a number stays empty.

Calendar invites report no bounces, so that cell stays blank, not zero. Never average a blank in.

TANTRA

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click-through = tagged visits ÷ sends

conversion = registrations ÷ sends
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The 1% and 3% lines are our decision rules, not an industry benchmark.

Day 3 of the workshop

The 3-Day AI RevOps Workshop

Next cohort Wed 11 Nov · 11:00 AM ET · three live sessions

You build the engine with us, not notes about it. Link in the comments.